Rainbow Summer Rolls with Peanut Dipping Sauce

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

Fresh, colourful and full of crunch, these summer rolls are lovely for a light lunch or a platter to share.

Serves 4–6 · Prep 30 min · Cook 5 min

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE SUMMER ROLLS

- 12 round rice paper wrappers, approximately 22 cm across
- Cold water, for softening the wrappers
- 75 g dried rice vermicelli noodles
- 1 cup mixed red, yellow and green capsicum, cut into thin strips
- 1 medium cucumber, cut into thin matchsticks
- 1 medium carrot, peeled and cut into thin matchsticks
- 1 cup finely shredded red cabbage
- 1 generous handful fresh coriander leaves

FOR THE PEANUT DIPPING SAUCE

- 2 tbsp creamy peanut butter
- 2 tbsp rice vinegar
- 3 tbsp soy sauce
- ½ tsp cayenne pepper, adjusted to taste
- 1 tbsp brown sugar
- Cold water, a little at a time, if needed to thin *(optional)*

METHOD

1. Prepare the noodles. Cook or soak the rice noodles according to the packet instructions. Drain, rinse under cold water and drain thoroughly. Cut into shorter lengths to make filling the rolls easier.
2. Prepare the vegetables. Cut the capsicums, cucumber and carrot into thin strips of a similar length. Finely shred the cabbage. Wash and dry the coriander leaves.
3. Make the sauce. Whisk together the peanut butter, rice vinegar, soy sauce, cayenne and brown sugar until smooth. Add cold water a teaspoon at a time, if needed, until the sauce reaches a dipping consistency.
4. Soften a wrapper. Fill a wide, shallow dish with cold water. Dip one rice paper wrapper into the water briefly, until wet and beginning to soften. Place on a clean, lightly damp work surface; it will continue softening as you fill it.
5. Add the filling. Arrange a few coriander leaves in the lower third of the wrapper, leaving space around the edges. Add a small portion of noodles, followed by capsicum, cucumber, carrot and cabbage.
6. Roll. Fold the bottom edge over the filling, fold both sides inward, then roll snugly to close. Repeat with the remaining wrappers and filling.
7. Arrange on a platter, leaving a little space between the rolls so they do not stick together. Serve with the peanut dipping sauce.

Tip

Have everything ready before you begin. Rolling is much easier with the vegetables, noodles and coriander arranged within reach.